



■ If your monitor is equipped with a manual degauss function, try to degauss the monitor to see if the colour dissipates. If this function is not available, turn the monitor off, wait for about 15 minutes, and turn the monitor back on.

■ Make sure the display resolution and refresh rates are within the specification of the monitor.



■ Do not spray any cleaning agent while the monitor is still warm—let it cool down first.

■ Never spray the solution directly on the screen as it could damage the coating.

■ Exercise caution while cleaning the on/off buttons and the control panel. Do not let the cleaning solution enter these areas.

■ Never spray anything on the vents on the backside of your monitor. This could cause damage to internal parts.

CD/DVD ROM

A CD or DVD-ROM is the most extensively used hardware peripheral. In order to extend its life, use a Lens cleaner at least once a month. One common mistake users tend to make is that



The wrong way to close the CD tray



The right way to close the CD tray

they sometimes close the disc-loading tray manually—this can result in misalignment of the tray due to the external force exerted by the human hand. It is highly recommended that you close the tray by pressing the button from the panel, and not by pushing it in.

Keyboard

The most used PC peripheral is also perhaps the dirtiest. To get your keyboard spanking clean, first lift it upside down so that all the loose dust particles fall off. Then use a vacuum cleaner to blow out the particles that have settled beneath the keys. Thereafter, unplug your keyboard, place it on a flat surface, spray the cleaning solution on a tissue, and scrub clean the areas that have dirt marks.

Ideally speaking, you should be cleaning your keyboard once in two months. On a more realistic level, try and do it at least once in three or four months. But if you've dropped something like jelly or raspberry jam, then there's no avoiding that cleaning session.



■ Do not use alcohol, solvent or anything that could remove the printing on the keys or melt the plastic.

■ Avoid spilling liquid (and food) on the keyboard as the food material may enter inside and render certain keys (or

Media care



■ Always keep the media (the CD) in a lined case so that it remains free from dust and scratches.

■ If you find dust settled on the media, clean it immediately with a soft clean cloth. Your CD-ROM drive can't read a dirty CD.

■ Make a habit of holding the CD from the edges, and always clean it from the centre to the outer portion.



■ For longevity of the media, do not expose it to direct sunlight.

■ Do not clean the media in a circular motion (even if it seems easier).

■ Make sure you don't leave any fingerprints on the CD.

even the entire keyboard) non-functional.

Mouse

Cleaning a mouse is one of the easiest tasks and we usually tend to open it whenever it gets slightly sluggish. This is how you should go about cleaning your mouse:

■ Turn off the PC and unplug the mouse.

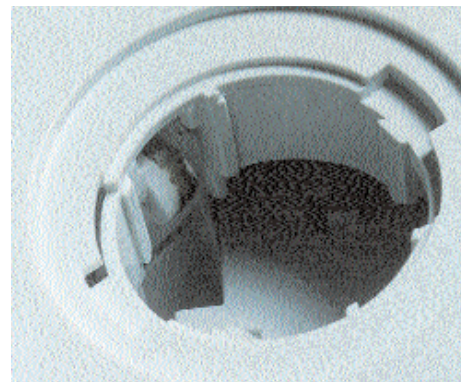
■ Open the 'locking ring' that holds the mouse ball in place (follow the arrows indicating the proper direction to turn and unlock).

■ Be careful with the mouse ball—moisten some paper napkins with Cologne (or any mild cleaning solution) and clean the mouse ball with a gentle rubbing motion. If the tissue gets dirty, change it and use another one.

■ Next, you will notice two rollers inside the mouse. Clean and wipe them with the cleaning solution. Let the mouse dry for a few minutes before using it.



Never use your nails or any other sharp device to clean the insides of the mouse.



Scanner

If you own a scanner, you'd often have found images marred with light or dark stripes or displaying a check board pattern. This indicates that it's time to clean your scanner glass.

■ Unplug the scanner.

■ Raise the front lid, apply a very mild streak of cleaning agent to a soft lint-free cloth, and clean the glass.

■ Wipe the glass with a soft cloth and wait for it to dry.



■ Make sure the transportation lock is enabled before you transport the scanner from one place to another. This prevents the CCD array mechanism tray from moving.

■ Always unplug your scanner before cleaning.